

Hey Rohan, good speaking with you today. Your question about Andrew Ng vs. Scaler was the sharpest one I heard all week -- and you deserve a straight answer, not a brochure.

Your questions answered

1 What is actually different from Coursera -- concretely

Andrew Ng is genuinely great for concepts, and if you could finish his courses, stay accountable, build projects, and land interviews on your own, you probably would have already. Scaler's structure is the product: **live classes 3x a week with industry instructors, 1:1 mentorship with active professionals, and 50+ hands-on projects** -- not video-and-quiz loops. The other piece is the exit ramp: **900+ hiring partners** and a **100,000+ alumni network** that Coursera has no equivalent of. You are paying for pace, accountability, and a structured path from your current TCS profile to a product-company interview pipeline -- not for content you could theoretically find elsewhere.

2 RAG, agents, evals -- is it actually in the curriculum or just marketing?

This is the right question to ask, and the answer is yes -- these are listed curriculum topics, not aspirational ones. The program explicitly covers **Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration** under the AI and Agents module, with an Agentic AI elective on top of that. Given your goal of building real LLM applications, that maps directly to what you said on the call: 'I want to build real LLM applications -- RAG, agents, evals.' How deep each module goes and what the project briefs look like for your specific cohort is something admissions can walk you through precisely -- happy to share specifics on your next call.

3 Will this actually move you past 14 LPA, or is it a lateral shuffle?

Your benchmark is clear: not 16 LPA at another service company -- a real product-company jump. The only verified salary figure we have is a **median ~110% hike for the DS/ML track** as published on Scaler's website, which is a data point, not a personal guarantee. What works in your favour is your profile: 4 YoE, B.Tech CSE from VIT, AWS cert already done, and banking-domain system exposure -- that is a stronger starting point than most switchers. For a realistic number tied to your background and target roles, the admissions team can pull actual alumni outcomes that match your profile; I would push hard for that data in your next call rather than accepting a range.

4 You are not too late -- but the window is not infinite

You said on the call: 'I keep seeing AI engineering roles and wondering if I'm already too late.' You are not -- 4 YoE with a systems background and an AWS cert is exactly the profile that product companies want to retrain into AI engineering, because you already understand infrastructure. The risk is not being too late today; it is waiting another 12

months while the market prices in AI fluency as a baseline expectation. The entrance test is the first concrete step -- it is also how you get access to the placement data and cohort details that will answer your remaining questions properly.

TODAY

Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.

TARGET PATH

Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.

NOW

Skills audit & entrance clarity

0-4 MO

Core foundations & habits

4-8 MO

Depth projects & design

8-12 MO

Interview readiness

Take the entrance test this week -- it is the only thing standing between you and the second call where you can get the hard placement numbers you asked for.